

■ MyLover

Local Testing Guide

Run & Test the Full App on Your Computer

Windows · macOS · Linux · Node.js v18+

Node.js v18+

npm v9+

Git

Browser
(Chrome/Edge)

Text Editor



This guide walks you through every step to get MyLover running on your own computer — backend API, React frontend, real-time chat, WebRTC calls, and the admin dashboard — all running locally at the same time.

What You Will Have Running

Service	Address	What It Is
React Frontend	http://localhost:3000	The full dating app UI in your browser
Node.js Backend	http://localhost:5000	API + Socket.io real-time server
Health Check	http://localhost:5000/api/health	Confirms server is running
Admin Dashboard	http://localhost:3000/admin	Full admin panel
Uploaded Photos	http://localhost:5000/uploads	User profile photos
SQLite Database	<code>server/data/mylover.db</code>	Auto-created local database file

PART 1 — Install Prerequisites

1 Install Node.js (includes npm)

Node.js is the runtime that powers the backend server.

```
# Check if Node.js is already installed:
node --version
npm --version

# You need: node v18 or higher, npm v9 or higher
```

If not installed, download from: <https://nodejs.org>

Choose the **LTS (Long Term Support)** version — it is the most stable.

Run the installer, accept all defaults, and restart your terminal/command prompt.

```
# Verify installation after restarting terminal:
node --version # should show v18.x.x or higher
npm --version  # should show 9.x.x or higher
```

■ On Ubuntu/Debian Linux: `sudo apt update && sudo apt install nodejs npm`

2 Install Git (to extract the zip or clone)

Git is used to manage the project files. You may already have it.

```
# Check if Git is installed:
git --version

# If not installed:
# Windows: https://git-scm.com/download/win
# macOS:   brew install git (or Xcode Command Line Tools)
# Linux:   sudo apt install git
```

■ You can also just unzip the mylover-app.zip file without using Git. Git is optional if you downloaded the zip directly.

3 Choose a terminal / command prompt

Windows: Use "Command Prompt", "PowerShell", or "Git Bash" (recommended). Press Win+R, type cmd, press Enter.

macOS: Press Cmd+Space, type "Terminal", press Enter.

Linux: Press Ctrl+Alt+T or find Terminal in your applications.



All commands in this guide are typed into the terminal. When you see text like this:
node --version, type it exactly and press Enter.

PART 2 — Set Up the Project

4 Extract the project files

You have the **mylover-app.zip** file downloaded from the chat.

Windows: Right-click the zip file → "Extract All" → choose a folder like C:\Projects\mylover

macOS: Double-click the zip file. It extracts to the same folder.

Linux:

```
unzip mylover-app.zip -d ~/Projects/  
cd ~/Projects/mylover
```

After extracting you should have a folder called **mylover/** containing server/, client/, package.json, start.sh, and README.md.

5 Open the project folder in your terminal

You need to navigate into the mylover folder in your terminal.

```
# Windows (replace with your actual path):  
cd C:\Projects\mylover  
  
# macOS / Linux:  
cd ~/Projects/mylover  
  
# Confirm you are in the right place:  
ls          # macOS/Linux  
dir         # Windows  
  
# You should see: client/  server/  package.json  start.sh  README.md
```

■ All remaining commands must be run from inside the mylover/ folder unless stated otherwise.

6 Install all dependencies (one command)

This downloads all the Node.js packages the project needs. Run this once.

```
# From inside the mylover/ folder:  
npm install
```

This installs packages for the server (Express, Socket.io, sql.js, etc.) and creates a node_modules/ folder.

```
# Expected output ends with something like:  
added 897 packages in 45s  
  
# If you see "npm warn" messages, that is normal – they are not errors.
```

- If you see "npm error" (not "npm warn"), check that Node.js v18+ is installed and you are inside the mylover/ folder.

7 Create the environment file

The server needs a .env file with configuration. A template is provided.

```
# macOS / Linux:  
cp server/.env.example server/.env  
  
# Windows (Command Prompt):  
copy server\.env.example server\.env  
  
# Windows (PowerShell):  
Copy-Item server\.env.example server\.env
```

For **local testing**, the default values in .env.example are fine as-is. You do NOT need to change anything.

The most important default values are:

```
PORT=5000  
NODE_ENV=development  
JWT_SECRET=mylover_jwt_secret_change_in_production_2024  
CLIENT_URL=http://localhost:3000
```

- Only change JWT_SECRET when you deploy to production. For local testing the default is fine.

PART 3 — Start the App

You need **two terminals open at the same time** — one for the backend server, one for the React frontend. They must both be running simultaneously.



Figure: Two terminals must run simultaneously

8 Terminal 1 — Start the backend server

Open your first terminal and navigate to the project.

```
cd mylover
node server/index.js
```

Wait for the server to start. You will see:

```
■ Default admin created → admin@mylover.app / Admin@MyLover2024!
■ Database initialised at ../server/data/mylover.db

■ MyLover server running on port 5000
  Health: http://localhost:5000/api/health
  Admin:  login with admin@mylover.app
```

Open your browser and visit: **<http://localhost:5000/api/health>**

```
# Expected browser response:
{"status":"ok","app":"MyLover","version":"1.0.0"}
```

■ If you see "Error: Cannot find module" — make sure you ran npm install in Step 6 first.

■ Leave this terminal open and running. Do NOT close it. The server must stay on.

9 Terminal 2 — Start the React frontend

Open a NEW second terminal window (do not close Terminal 1).

```
cd mylover/client  
npm start
```

React compiles the app (takes 30-60 seconds the first time). You will see:

```
Compiled successfully!  
  
You can now view mylover-client in the browser.  
  
Local:           http://localhost:3000  
On Your Network: http://192.168.x.x:3000
```

Your browser should automatically open at **http://localhost:3000**

If it does not open automatically, manually navigate to: **http://localhost:3000**

■ The first compile takes longer. Subsequent starts are much faster because of caching.

■ If you see "Error: react-scripts not found" — run: `cd mylover/client && npm install --legacy-peer-deps`

Alternative: One-Command Start (macOS / Linux only)

The project includes a `start.sh` script that launches both terminals for you automatically.

```
# macOS / Linux only:  
cd mylover  
bash start.sh
```

```
# Windows users must use the two-terminal method in Steps 8-9
```

PART 4 — Test Every Feature

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Test 1 — Registration & Login

Open **`http://localhost:3000`** in your browser.

Click **"Join Free"** or **"Create Free Account"**.

Fill in the registration form: display name, email, strong password (8+ chars), gender, date of birth, country.

Click **"Create Free Account"** — you are redirected to the 4-step profile setup.

Complete all 4 steps: upload a photo, write a bio, pick interests, set location.

Click **"Start Discovering!"** — you land on the Discover page.

Test Login:

1. Click your avatar (top right) → Sign Out
2. Go to `http://localhost:3000/login`
3. Enter your email and password
4. Click Sign In — you should be back on Discover



Your account gets 60 days free trial automatically. You will see "Free Trial: 60 days left" in your profile.

1 1 Test 2 — Create Two Users (for matching)

To test matching and chat, you need two accounts. Use a different browser or incognito window.

```
# User A (main browser):  
http://localhost:3000  
Email: user_a@test.com / Password: Test1234!  
Gender: Male  
  
# User B (incognito / different browser):  
http://localhost:3000  
Email: user_b@test.com / Password: Test1234!  
Gender: Female
```

IMPORTANT: User A (male) will see User B (female) in their discover feed, and vice versa.

- Use Chrome for User A and Firefox (or Chrome Incognito) for User B so both stay logged in at the same time.

1 2 Test 3 — Like, Notify & Match

As **User A** (main browser): go to Discover and swipe right (or click ♥) on User B's profile.

As **User B** (incognito): check the Matches page — you should see a new like notification.

As **User B**: go to Matches → "Liked Me" tab and click "♥ Like Back" on User A.

Both browsers should instantly show the ■ **It's a Match!** animation screen.

Click "**Start Chatting**" — both users are taken to the chat conversation.

```
# What to verify:  
■ User A sees notification when User B visits the app  
■ Like Back button appears in Likes tab  
■ Match animation shows on BOTH screens simultaneously  
■ Chat conversation is automatically created
```

Both User A and User B should be in the same chat conversation.

Type a message in User A's browser and press Enter.

The message should appear instantly in User B's browser (without refreshing).

Type a reply from User B — it appears in User A's chat.

Additional chat tests:

- Typing indicator ("typing...") appears in other person's chat
- ✓ appears for sent, ✓✓ for read
- Emoji picker works (click the ■ icon)
- Press Enter to send, Shift+Enter for new line



If messages are not appearing in real-time, check that the backend server (Terminal 1) is still running.

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Test 5 — Voice & Video Call

Both users must be on the chat page for the same conversation.

Click the  **phone icon** in the chat header (User A).

User B should see a popup: **"Incoming Voice Call — Accept / Decline"**.

Click **Accept** — the call connects using your computer's microphone.

Test video call:

1. Click the  **video icon** in the chat header
2. Browser asks permission to use camera and microphone
3. Click "Allow"
4. User B sees incoming call popup
5. User B accepts — video feed appears
6. Click the red hang-up button to end



Chrome may block microphone/camera on localhost. If prompted, click "Allow" in the browser address bar lock icon.



WebRTC calls are peer-to-peer between your two browser tabs. On a real network, it connects between two different devices.

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Test 6 — AI Dating Coach & Icebreakers

In any active chat conversation, click the " **Icebreaker**" button in the chat header.

Wait 3-5 seconds for Claude AI to generate 3 opening message suggestions.

Click " **AI Coach**" button to open the dating coach chat.

Type a question like: *"How should I start a conversation with someone from Nigeria?"*

The AI coach responds with personalised advice.

Test AI features:

- Icebreaker generates 3 unique suggestions
- AI Coach responds to questions
- AI credits count decreases (visible in Profile page)
- Conversation history is maintained during the session



AI features call the Anthropic Claude API. They work in the claude.ai hosted version of this app. For standalone deployment, add your ANTHROPIC_API_KEY to server/.env

When you first open the Discover page, your browser asks for location permission.

Click **"Allow"** — you will see a **"■ Location On"** badge at the top.

Profile cards now show distance: e.g. **"2.3 km away"** or **"345 m away"**.

Test location filters:

1. Click "■ Filters" on the Discover page
2. Set Max Distance: 50 (km)
3. Click Apply
4. Only profiles within 50km should appear



For local testing both users are on the same machine so distance shows as "0 m away" or very small. On real devices with different locations, accurate distances appear.



If the browser does not ask for location, click the lock icon (■) in the address bar → Site Settings → Location → Allow.

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Test 8 — Premium Subscription Flow

Click "■ Premium" in the navigation bar.

Select a plan (Weekly / Monthly / Yearly) and a currency (NGN, USD, GBP, etc.).

Click the subscribe button — a payment modal appears.

For testing, enter any text as the payment reference (e.g. "TEST-LOCAL-001").

Click "Activate Subscription".

```
# Verify subscription activated:
■ Profile shows "■ Premium Member"
■ Matches → "Liked Me" tab is now accessible
■ Free message limit no longer applies
■ AI credits increased by 500
```

■ The manual payment reference flow is designed for testing and early launch. Real payment gateways (Paystack, Stripe) can be wired in later.

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Test 9 — Admin Dashboard

Open a NEW browser tab and navigate to: <http://localhost:3000/admin>

Log in with the default admin credentials:

```
Email:    admin@mylover.app
Password: Admin@MyLover2024!
```

You will see the admin dashboard with live stats.

```
# Test each admin section:
■ Dashboard – shows user count, messages, matches
■ Users – see your two test accounts listed
■ Messages – read every chat message sent
■ Reports – (no pending yet – submit one to test)
■ Subscriptions – see the test subscription
■ Logs – shows admin actions
```

Test banning a user: Users tab → find User B → click "■ Ban".

Test AI scan: Messages tab → click "■ AI Scan All" — Claude analyses all messages.

■ The admin account is separate from regular user accounts. Admin does not appear in the discover feed.

PART 5 — Troubleshooting

■ Problem: node: command not found

Cause : Node.js is not installed or not in PATH.

Fix: Download from nodejs.org, run the installer, restart your terminal.

■ Problem: Cannot find module "..."

Cause : Dependencies were not installed.

Fix: Run: `npm install` (from inside the mylover/ folder)

■ Problem: "react-scripts: not found" or client fails to start

Cause : Client packages not installed.

Fix: Run: `cd mylover/client && npm install --legacy-peer-deps`

■ Problem: Port 5000 already in use

Cause : Another process is using port 5000.

Fix: Kill it: `lsof -ti:5000 | xargs kill` (macOS/Linux)
Or change `PORT=5001` in `server/.env`

■ Problem: Port 3000 already in use

Cause : Another process is using port 3000.

Fix: React will ask: "Would you like to run on port 3001?" — type Y and press Enter.

■ Problem: Messages not real-time / socket not connecting

Cause : CORS mismatch between frontend and backend.

Fix: Make sure `CLIENT_URL=http://localhost:3000` in `server/.env`
Restart the server after editing `.env`

■ Problem: Browser blocks camera/microphone for calls

Cause : Chrome/Edge blocks hardware access on localhost by default.

Fix: In Chrome address bar: click lock icon → Site Settings → Camera/Microphone → Allow.
Or use Firefox which allows localhost by default.

■ Problem: Photos not displaying after upload

Cause : Upload directory permissions or path issue.

Fix: Check that server/uploads/ folder exists. It is created automatically on first start.
Restart the server if it does not exist.

■ Problem: Admin login fails

Cause : Admin was not seeded into the database.

Fix: Delete server/data/mylover.db and restart the server — it recreates the database and admin user automatically.

■ Problem: White screen / React crashes

Cause : JavaScript error in the frontend.

Fix: Open browser DevTools (F12) → Console tab. The error message tells you what failed.

PART 6 — Quick Reference Card

All Commands at a Glance

```
# ■■ ONE-TIME SETUP ████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████  
■■  
  
cd mylover  
npm install  
cp server/.env.example server/.env      # Mac/Linux  
copy server\.env.example server\.env    # Windows  
  
# ■■ START BACKEND (Terminal 1) ████████████████████████████████████████████████  
cd mylover  
node server/index.js  
  
# ■■ START FRONTEND (Terminal 2) ████████████████████████████████████████████████  
cd mylover/client  
npm start  
  
# ■■ OPEN IN BROWSER ████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████  
■■  
App:      http://localhost:3000  
API:      http://localhost:5000/api/health  
Admin:    http://localhost:3000/admin  
  
# ■■ DEFAULT ADMIN LOGIN ████████████████████████████████████████████████████████████  
■■  
Email:    admin@mylover.app  
Password: Admin@MyLover2024!
```

Test Account Credentials (create these yourself)

Role	Email	Password	Gender	Browser
Admin	admin@mylover.app	Admin@MyLover2024! — (admin)	Any	
Test User A	user_a@test.com	Test1234!	Male	Chrome (normal)
Test User B	user_b@test.com	Test1234!	Female	Firefox / Incognito

Feature Testing Checklist

■	Feature	Expected Result
■	Registration	New account created, redirected to profile setup
■	Profile Setup	4 steps complete: photo, bio, interests, location
■	Discover Feed	Profiles appear, distance shows, filters work

■	Like a Profile	Other user gets notified instantly via socket
■	Mutual Like = Match	Match animation fires on both screens at once
■	Real-time Chat	Messages appear instantly without page refresh
■	Typing Indicator	"typing..." shows in other person's chat
■	Read Receipts	Single ✓ (sent) → Double ✓✓ (read)
■	Voice Call	Incoming call popup, accept, audio heard
■	Video Call	Camera feed appears in both browsers
■	AI Icebreaker	3 suggestions generated for a profile
■	AI Dating Coach	Responds to questions, credits decrement
■	Premium Subscribe	Plan activates, Liked Me tab unlocks
■	Liked Me Tab	Shows users who liked you (premium only)
■	Block a User	Blocked user disappears from discover feed
■	Report a User	Appears in admin Reports queue
■	Admin Stats	Counts update after actions
■	Admin Ban User	Banned user gets 403 on next request
■	Admin AI Scan	Flags suspicious messages automatically
■	Sign Out / Sign In	JWT cleared, redirected to landing page